

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Baristas and Cafe Staff English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Baristas, cafe counter staff, and coffee pickup staff.

All orders, prices, recipes, promotions, and incidents are fictional language practice, not barista certification, allergen-control training, health advice, or equipment-maintenance instruction. Recipes and terminology vary by cafe. Use current workplace information and refer suitability or equipment questions to the designated lead. This course focuses on counter and coffee-bar exchanges, not hospitality management.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

- 01 Two drinks, one speaker
- 02 The guest uses a drink name from another cafe
- 03 A colleague's reassurance needs correcting
- 04 A collection estimate changes
- 05 A remake shouldn't become a second sale
- 06 Choosing between two bags for someone else
- 07 The display price and order price differ
- 08 The closing worker inherits a customer query

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

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FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Two drinks, one speaker

A barista separates specifications when one person orders two similar drinks.

Roles: Barista / Customer

Barista: You mentioned two lattes, one different from the other. Let's check each drink separately.

Customer: The first is a small hot latte with whole milk, for me to drink here.

Barista: Thanks. Is that first latte standard coffee, or would you like the decaf option today?

Customer: Standard coffee. The second one is decaf, and it needs to be iced for my colleague.

Barista: What size would your colleague like, and should that second drink also use whole milk?

Customer: A large, with oat drink instead. They're taking it away rather than staying in the cafe.

Barista: I'll attach the oat choice to the large iced decaf only, not to your small hot latte.

Customer: That's right. Can you put separate names on them so we don't mix them up?

Barista: Yes. What names should I use for your drink and for your colleague's takeaway order?

Customer: Mine is Rowan, and theirs is Lee. Please don't add any syrups to either drink.

Barista: Rowan: small hot standard latte, whole milk. Lee: large iced decaf latte, oat drink; neither has syrup.

Customer: Exactly. Mine is for here and Lee's is takeaway. Those final details match what we want.

Notice the professional language

'Attach the choice to' links a modifier to one drink, preventing it from spreading to both.

'Neither' applies the no-syrup instruction to both drinks without repeating the full specifications.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The guest uses a drink name from another cafe

A barista checks expectations because drink names and recipes differ between businesses.

Roles: Customer / Barista

Customer: I usually order a flat white elsewhere. Will yours come in exactly the same cup size?

Barista: Not necessarily. Our menu lists this size and recipe; I can explain them before you decide.

Customer: At the other place it's quite small, with little foam. That's what I'm hoping to find here.

Barista: Our listed version is small, but I shouldn't assume its texture or coffee balance matches theirs exactly.

Customer: Could you compare it with your latte using the details your own menu actually gives?

Barista: Yes. Our latte option is larger and milkier; the flat white description emphasizes a smaller, coffee-forward drink.

Customer: Coffee-forward means I should notice the coffee flavor more, rather than that you guarantee extra caffeine?

Barista: That's the intended flavor description. It doesn't provide a measured caffeine amount or guarantee how it will taste.

Customer: Then the smaller option sounds closer. Please use your normal recipe rather than trying to copy theirs.

Barista: Of course. Would you like the whole milk shown in that recipe, or a listed alternative?

Customer: Whole milk is fine. I'm ordering based on this menu now, not assuming both cafes are identical.

Barista: I'll enter one small flat white with whole milk and repeat the price before we take payment.

Notice the professional language

'Coffee-forward' describes flavor emphasis; it isn't a numeric caffeine claim.

'Not necessarily' rejects an unsupported equivalence without saying the two drinks must be completely different.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A colleague's reassurance needs correcting

A barista repairs an earlier overstatement before the customer orders.

Roles: Barista / Customer

Barista: I need to correct something I said earlier: choosing almond drink doesn't let me guarantee this drink is dairy-free.

Customer: Thank you for coming back. I was about to order based on that assurance.

Barista: I should have separated the milk choice from the other ingredients and the equipment we use.

Customer: My concern is a milk allergy, not simply preferring one flavor. Can someone explain the actual arrangements?

Barista: Yes. Our lead can check the product information and discuss shared equipment before you choose.

Customer: Please leave the drink unmade for now. I don't want a remake of something already prepared.

Barista: I will. The order is still pending, and I haven't sent it to the bar.

Customer: Could the lead also check the chocolate topping? It isn't obvious what that contains.

Barista: I'll pass on that specific topping question as well as your reported milk allergy.

Customer: And please don't substitute another plant drink without asking me. I haven't chosen an alternative yet.

Barista: Understood. No replacement drink or ingredient is selected. I'll bring the lead over to discuss the details.

Customer: That's helpful. I can decide after that conversation instead of relying on the earlier general reassurance.

Notice the professional language

shared equipment - Equipment used for more than one product, relevant to questions about possible allergen cross-contact.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A collection estimate changes

A barista updates a mobile-order customer whose original estimate no longer fits the queue.

Roles: Customer / Barista

Customer: The app estimated collection at ten past, and it's fifteen past now. Has my order been missed?

Barista: I'll check the full order number. The displayed estimate isn't the same as a ready notification.

Customer: It's order ninety-one. I need two coffees before my bus, which leaves in ten minutes.

Barista: The order is received, but neither drink is complete yet. The bar currently estimates another six minutes.

Customer: That leaves very little time. Are you promising they'll be ready within those six minutes?

Barista: No, that's the current estimate. I can ask the lead about your options if the wait won't work.

Customer: Please ask about canceling, but don't cancel it without checking back with me first.

Barista: Understood. I'll request the options, keep the order status clear, and return before making any change.

Customer: Could you tell the bar I'm asking about cancellation so they don't get a contradictory message?

Barista: The lead confirms neither drink has started, so we can cancel now. Would you prefer that, or wait?

Customer: I'd like to cancel, please. I haven't got time to wait for the drinks.

Barista: I'll confirm the cancellation with the lead and ask them to explain the payment outcome.

Notice the professional language

'Considering cancellation' differs from authorizing it; the customer's later statement supplies the choice.

'Current estimate' provides useful timing without making a guaranteed completion claim.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

A remake shouldn't become a second sale

A counter worker checks an apparent duplicate charge associated with a remake.

Roles: Customer / Counter worker

Customer: I paid for one latte and received a remake. Why does this receipt show two drinks?

Counter worker: Let me compare the receipt with the order record before explaining that second line.

Customer: The first cup had the wrong milk choice. Your colleague said they would replace it.

Counter worker: I can see the original drink and another entry. I need the lead to confirm how it was recorded.

Customer: Please don't process anything else on my payment card while you're checking that entry.

Counter worker: I won't request another payment. I'll show the lead the receipt and your explanation.

Customer: Does the word remake itself prove the second charge has already been removed?

Counter worker: No, it describes the replacement drink. The bill record needs a separate check.

Customer: Could you ask whether the second entry was accidental and request a corrected receipt?

Counter worker: Yes, the lead has approved the correction. I'll provide the updated receipt once it's recorded.

Customer: Thank you. The replacement drink was right; the remaining problem was only the duplicate charge.

Counter worker: I'll check the receipt shows one drink charge and ask the lead to explain any payment adjustment.

Notice the professional language

'Associated with' doesn't establish why an entry appeared; the record still needs checking.

'Remaining problem' narrows the issue after the drink itself has been corrected.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

Choosing between two bags for someone else

A barista helps compare beans without guessing the recipient's preferences.

Roles: Customer / Barista

Customer: I need a coffee gift, but the two bags have different tasting notes and roast descriptions.

Barista: Do you know what the recipient usually enjoys, or would you prefer to compare the printed descriptions first?

Customer: They mentioned liking chocolate-like flavors. I don't know whether they prefer a particular roast level.

Barista: This bag lists chocolate notes, while the other lists citrus notes. Those are descriptions, not promised personal reactions.

Customer: Could you guarantee they'll like the first bag because they used the same flavor word?

Barista: I can't guarantee their preference, but that description gives you a relevant reason to consider it.

Customer: Then I'll choose the first bag. Should I have it ground before giving it to them?

Barista: Do you know their brewer? Without that detail, leaving the beans whole preserves their later choice.

Customer: They have a grinder, so whole beans should make sense. Please keep the package intact.

Barista: Certainly. Would you like to see the roast date and price before we complete the purchase?

Customer: Yes, please. I want to include the product details with the gift rather than invent a description.

Barista: Here they are. I'll sell the whole-bean bag as labeled, with no grinding or added flavoring requested.

Notice the professional language

tasting notes - Descriptors suggesting a coffee's perceived flavors, not necessarily added ingredients.

roast date - The date shown for when coffee was roasted, not when the package was purchased.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The display price and order price differ

A customer queries a drink price while the counter worker checks the selected modifiers.

Roles: Customer / Counter worker

Customer: The menu says four dollars, but the screen shows five fifty. Can you explain the difference?

Counter worker: Let's compare the base drink with the changes on your ticket before you pay.

Customer: I asked for oat drink and an extra shot. I didn't realize both had separate prices.

Counter worker: The oat change adds fifty cents, and the extra shot adds one dollar to the four-dollar drink.

Customer: That explains five fifty. Could I remove the extra shot but keep the oat choice?

Counter worker: Yes, because the drink hasn't been sent to the bar. That revised drink would cost four fifty.

Customer: Please make that change. I want the same cup size, not a smaller drink.

Counter worker: I'll remove only the extra-shot modifier. The size and oat choice remain exactly as you requested.

Customer: Does that also change the coffee to decaf, or are those separate choices?

Counter worker: They're separate. Your ticket still says standard coffee; removing an extra shot doesn't select decaf.

Customer: Then the revised order is right. Let me see the four-fifty total before paying.

Counter worker: Here it is: the four-dollar drink plus the fifty-cent oat upcharge, with no extra-shot charge.

Notice the professional language

'Base drink' means the starting menu item before selected changes.

'Remove only' limits the correction so unrelated order choices are preserved.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 12 SPEAKING TURNS

The closing worker inherits a customer query

A departing barista transfers an unfinished receipt query to the incoming counter worker.

Roles: Outgoing barista / Incoming worker

Outgoing barista: Before I leave, one customer is waiting for an itemized receipt from an earlier mobile order.

Incoming worker: Do you have the order number, or should I ask them to explain everything again?

Outgoing barista: It's one-forty-six, under Avery. They received their drinks and paid; only the receipt query remains.

Incoming worker: Thanks. Have you already printed the itemized version, or is that still the action needed?

Outgoing barista: I found the completed transaction but haven't printed the itemized receipt. The lead is checking that option.

Incoming worker: I'll take the follow-up with the lead. I won't treat this as a new unpaid drink order.

Outgoing barista: Exactly. The customer doesn't want another payment or changes to the original drink specifications.

Incoming worker: I'll tell them I've taken over and ask the lead whether the requested receipt is available.

Outgoing barista: Please also explain if only a payment receipt is available; don't promise item detail we can't provide.

Incoming worker: Understood. Completed order, completed payment, itemized receipt still unresolved. Is there another issue attached to this customer?

Outgoing barista: No other issue. The till review is separate and remains with the lead, not this customer.

Incoming worker: I'll keep the two matters distinct and return to Avery with the lead's answer about the receipt.

Notice the professional language

mobile order - An order placed through a phone app or similar online ordering service.

Rehearse this dialogue with an AI partner

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Taking a precise drink order

SHARED CASE

A customer says 'a regular latte.' This cafe uses regular for its middle size, but the customer might mean caffeinated coffee or the usual milk. No drink has been made. Clarify size, hot or iced, and coffee choice separately.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify a familiar word that can describe several order details. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Customer: you mean middle size; choose hot, decaf, and whole milk when asked.

Useful expressions

By regular, do you mean ___?

Would you like that hot or ___?

That's a ___ latte with ___, for ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

When you say regular, do you mean our middle size or caffeinated coffee? I'll check those separately so I enter the right drink. Would you like the latte hot or iced, and which milk would you prefer? Once those details are clear, I'll repeat the full order before sending it to the bar.

Second round

The customer says 'the normal one' about milk. Ask for the actual milk choice.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Comparing drinks without overclaiming

SHARED CASE

In this fictional cafe, the small latte and small cappuccino both contain the same espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam; the latte has more liquid milk. The customer wants less foam, not more caffeine. Compare the two using those facts.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain this cafe's options without presenting a universal recipe. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Customer: you want a milky drink with less foam, not a caffeine estimate.

Useful expressions

Both use ___, but ___ has more ___.

When you say strong, are you asking about ___?

For your preference for ___, ___ may suit you.

Cover this until after your first attempt

In our small drinks, both choices use the same espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam, while the latte has more liquid milk. Since you're asking for less foam rather than more coffee, the latte sounds closer to that preference. I wouldn't use how strong it tastes as an exact measure of caffeine.

Second round

The customer asks whether a stronger taste guarantees more caffeine. Explain the limit.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

SHARED CASE

A customer reports a milk allergy and asks for an oat latte without vanilla syrup. The barista knows oat drink is available but has not checked its current ingredients or shared-equipment arrangements. No claim of suitability can be made from the drink name.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify sweetness and allergy questions as separate issues. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Customer: state the milk allergy and ask about shared equipment before choosing.

Useful expressions

Do you mean no syrup, or ___?

I can confirm ___ is available, but not yet ___.

Let me ask the lead about ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

I can note oat drink and no vanilla syrup, but those changes don't by themselves establish suitability for your milk allergy. I need to check the current product information and ask our lead about shared equipment. Let's leave the drink unmade while we get those details, so you can decide with accurate information.

Second round

A colleague says plant-based always means suitable. Explain what that label doesn't establish.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Managing the queue and pickup

SHARED CASE

Two customers named Sam have orders. Ticket 64 is a small hot latte and is complete. Ticket 67 is a large iced decaf latte and is in progress. The customer collecting 67 hears 'Sam' and reaches for 64. Clarify using ticket and drink details.

Role A | Responding professional

Use a second identifier when names are duplicated. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Customer: you are Sam with ticket 67 and expect an iced drink.

Useful expressions

Which ticket number are you collecting?

This is ____; your order is ____.

____ is complete, while ____ is in progress.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Are you collecting ticket sixty-seven, the large iced decaf latte? This completed drink is a small hot latte on sixty-four for another Sam. Your order is still in progress. I'll use the ticket number as well as the name when I call it, so the two orders don't get mixed up.

Second round

The label is partly hidden. Check the ticket rather than guessing from the name.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Handling remakes and mistaken labels

SHARED CASE

Ticket 22 requests a small iced latte with no syrup, but the cup label says hot vanilla latte. The customer hasn't collected it. A replacement is available; its wait hasn't been checked. Correct the mismatch without claiming a refund or a serving time.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge the error and confirm the replacement details. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Customer: keep the original iced, no-syrup order and ask about the wait.

Useful expressions

The ticket says ____; the label says ____.

Would you still like ____?

I'll check the remake time before ____.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The cup label doesn't match your ticket: you ordered a small iced latte with no syrup, but this label says hot vanilla. I'm sorry for that mix-up. I'll request a fresh drink with your confirmed details and check the wait before giving you an estimate. Is the original order still what you'd like?

Second round

The bar offers a different size. Check whether the customer wants that change rather than assuming.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Discussing coffee beans for home

SHARED CASE

A customer buys a gift bag and asks for 'normal ground.' They don't know the recipient's brewer. This cafe sells the same coffee whole or ground. Grinding cannot be undone. The package's 'hazelnut' note describes flavor, not an ingredient statement.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish grind requirements and flavor descriptions from assumptions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Customer: you are buying a gift and don't know the brewer; decide whether to keep the bag whole.

Useful expressions

What kind of brewer do they use?

Would you prefer to leave the beans ___?

That phrase describes flavor, not ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you tell me what kind of brewer the recipient uses? There isn't one grind described as normal for every brewer, and grinding can't be undone. We can leave this bag whole while you check. Also, the hazelnut tasting note describes a flavor impression; it isn't the ingredient information for an allergy question.

Second round

The customer asks whether 'hazelnut notes' guarantees an ingredient is absent. Refer to actual product information.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

SHARED CASE

A fictional cafe lists a latte at \$4, an oat-drink upcharge of \$0.50, and a pastry at \$3. The \$6 combo includes a standard latte and pastry; the oat upcharge still applies. Explain \$6.50 for that combo, versus \$7.50 separately, before payment.

Role A | Responding professional

State included items and additional charges before the customer commits. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Customer: compare the oat combo with the separate prices and choose one.

Useful expressions

The combo includes ___ at ___.

The ___ upcharge still applies, making ___.

Separately, the same items total ___.

Cover this until after your first attempt

The standard latte-and-pastry combo is six dollars. Your oat-drink choice adds fifty cents, so that combination is six fifty. Bought separately, the four-dollar latte, fifty-cent change, and three-dollar pastry would total seven fifty. The combo saves one dollar for these items; shall I enter that option with the oat choice?

Second round

The selected pastry sells out before payment. Ask whether the customer wants the remaining pastry; don't substitute silently.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Handing over the bar and till

SHARED CASE

At 2:00, ticket 108's coffee is complete but its tea is pending. Large takeaway lids are unavailable, though small lids remain. The outgoing worker counted the till, but the lead's reconciliation is pending. Assign the tea and stock follow-up without calling the till signed off.

Role A | Responding professional

Hand over orders, supplies, and a till question without merging them. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

Incoming worker: accept the tea follow-up and large-lid query; ask who retains the till review.

Useful expressions

___ is complete; ___ remains on the queue.

We're out of ___, not ___.

I've counted ___; ___ is still pending.

Cover this until after your first attempt

Ticket one-oh-eight still needs its tea; the coffee is complete. Large takeaway lids are out, but small lids remain. Can you take the tea order and confirm the large-lid situation with the lead? I've counted the till, but reconciliation isn't complete. I'll stay responsible for that review until the lead takes it.

Second round

A coworker says the till 'looks about right.' Keep the unresolved record comparison explicit.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Regular needs three checks

The ambiguous latte order from the case.

01 • Customer: Could I have a regular latte, please, and make that one to go?

02 • Barista: By regular, do you mean our middle size or the caffeinated coffee option?

03 • Customer: The middle size. I'd actually like decaf because I've already had coffee today.

04 • Barista: Certainly. Would you like that latte hot or iced on this order?

05 • Customer: Hot, please. I didn't realize regular could refer to more than the size.

06 • Barista: It can. Which milk would you like? We have whole milk and the listed alternatives.

07 • Customer: Whole milk is fine. I don't want any syrup added to the drink.

08 • Barista: That's one middle-size hot decaf latte, whole milk, no syrup, to take away.

09 • Customer: Yes, that's everything. Please use the name Ellis when you call the order.

10 • Barista: Ellis, thank you. I'll put that name with those specifications on your ticket.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A shot is not a bigger cup

A customer asks what an extra-shot option changes.

01 • Customer: Does choosing an extra shot make the drink come in a bigger cup?

02 • Barista: No, it adds espresso under our menu option; the cup size stays the same.

03 • Customer: I want a larger drink, not extra coffee in the size I already chose.

04 • Barista: Then let's change the size rather than automatically add an extra shot to it.

05 • Customer: Thank you. What's the price difference between the small and large sizes here?

06 • Barista: The large is one dollar more. An extra shot has a separate listed charge.

07 • Customer: I'll take the large standard version, then, without choosing that extra-shot option today.

08 • Barista: Understood. Large latte, standard coffee recipe, with no separately added extra shot.

09 • Customer: And still hot with whole milk, as I said when I first ordered.

10 • Barista: Yes, those choices stay unchanged. I'll repeat the final ticket before taking payment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Leaving room is an amount request

A customer clarifies space in a filter-coffee cup.

01 • Barista: You asked me to leave room. How much space would you like for your milk?

02 • Customer: Just a little at the top, not a cup that's only half full.

03 • Barista: Thanks. Would you like the milk added here, or served separately for you?

04 • Customer: Separately, please. I'd like to decide how much to add at the table.

05 • Barista: I'll note room for milk and a separate serving, with no syrup added.

06 • Customer: Yes. This is for drinking here, so I don't need a takeaway lid.

07 • Barista: A dine-in cup, then. Is the coffee choice still the house filter?

08 • Customer: It is. I haven't changed the coffee itself, only how it's served today.

09 • Barista: Understood. House filter with room and milk separately, for here rather than takeaway.

10 • Customer: Exactly. Thank you for checking what I meant before reducing the amount too much.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Taking a precise drink order

A customer says 'a regular latte.' This cafe uses regular for its middle size, but the customer might mean caffeinated coffee or the usual milk. No drink has been made. Clarify size, hot or iced, and coffee choice separately.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you mean middle size; choose hot, decaf, and whole milk when asked.

Second round: The customer says 'the normal one' about milk. Ask for the actual milk choice.

Scenario 2 | Hot order, iced label

A customer orders a small hot decaf latte. Before payment, the screen shows small iced decaf latte. Milk choice is correct.

Role A: Barista: read the screen and correct temperature style.

Role B: Customer: confirm hot, not iced; keep the other choices.

Possible opening: I have iced on the screen, but I heard hot. Which did you want?

Success checks

- Obtain hot or iced explicitly.
- Keep decaf and size unchanged.
- Read back the corrected order.

Add a complication: The customer says 'same as before,' but the previous order isn't visible.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Less foam, not more coffee

The small-drink comparison in the case.

01 • Customer: Which has more coffee, your small latte or small cappuccino? I dislike too much foam.

02 • Barista: Both use the same espresso serving here, but their milk and foam balance differs.

03 • Customer: Then choosing the latte wouldn't automatically mean ordering a different espresso amount at this cafe?

04 • Barista: Correct. Our small latte has more liquid milk, while the cappuccino has more foam.

05 • Customer: The latte sounds closer to what I mean. I want something milky, not especially foamy.

06 • Barista: Would you like the small latte, then, with its usual milk balance and no additions?

07 • Customer: Yes, please. Does a drink tasting stronger always mean it contains more caffeine?

08 • Barista: Not necessarily. Taste alone doesn't establish caffeine content, and I don't have exact figures.

09 • Customer: That's enough information. Please keep the standard coffee recipe rather than adding an extra shot.

10 • Barista: Certainly. One small latte with the standard recipe; no extra shot requested.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An Americano is not filter coffee

A customer wants the brewed-coffee option on the menu.

01 • Customer: I'd like brewed filter coffee. Is that the same menu item as an Americano?

02 • Barista: They're different here. The Americano starts with espresso and water; filter coffee uses our filter brew.

03 • Customer: I see. Which one comes from the batch you have on the counter now?

04 • Barista: The house filter comes from that batch. The Americano is a separate drink order.

05 • Customer: Then I'll choose the house filter. Is milk automatically included in the cup?

06 • Barista: No, we can offer it separately if you'd like. Would you prefer coffee alone?

07 • Customer: Coffee alone, please. I mainly wanted to avoid ordering an espresso-based drink by mistake.

08 • Barista: Understood. A small house filter, black, with no added milk or syrup on this order.

09 • Customer: That works. Could you tell me which bean is being used for today's filter?

10 • Barista: The board names today's house blend. I'll show you its current description beside the price.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Strong can mean flavor

A barista clarifies a taste preference without caffeine claims.

01 • Barista: When you ask for stronger coffee, do you mean a more pronounced flavor or more caffeine?

02 • Customer: A more pronounced flavor. I usually find my drink tastes mostly of milk.

03 • Barista: Thanks. We can compare our smaller milk drink with your usual large latte.

04 • Customer: Would that be a comparison of the milk balance rather than a guaranteed caffeine increase?

05 • Barista: Exactly. The menu descriptions can help with flavor balance, but I can't promise your perception.

06 • Customer: I'd like to hear the smaller option's description and price before changing my order.

07 • Barista: This one has less milk in our recipe and costs four dollars today.

08 • Customer: I'll try that. Please keep the standard recipe rather than invent a special strength setting.

09 • Barista: Certainly. I'll enter the named menu drink so the bar follows the correct recipe.

10 • Customer: Thank you. I meant stronger in taste, and that distinction helped me choose.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Comparing drinks without overclaiming

In this fictional cafe, the small latte and small cappuccino both contain the same espresso serving. The cappuccino has more foam; the latte has more liquid milk. The customer wants less foam, not more caffeine. Compare the two using those facts.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you want a milky drink with less foam, not a caffeine estimate.

Second round: The customer asks whether a stronger taste guarantees more caffeine. Explain the limit.

Scenario 2 | Foam is the deciding factor

The menu offers two small milk drinks with the same stated espresso serving. One is described as having more foam. The customer wants that texture.

Role A: Barista: compare foam without promising caffeine content.

Role B: Customer: choose the foamier option after clarification.

Possible opening: Are you asking about the foam layer or the coffee amount?

Success checks

- Clarify lighter.
- Use this cafe's recipe descriptions.
- Read back the chosen drink.

Add a complication: The customer uses 'lighter' to mean airy texture, not lower caffeine.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Oat is a choice, not a guarantee

The oat-latte question from the case.

01 • Customer: I have a milk allergy. Could I have an oat latte without vanilla syrup?

02 • Barista: I can note those choices, but I need to check the ingredients and equipment arrangements.

03 • Customer: Isn't using oat drink enough to answer that? I thought it replaced all dairy milk.

04 • Barista: It replaces the milk choice, but doesn't settle every ingredient or cross-contact question.

05 • Customer: Then please ask whoever can explain those details before you start making the drink.

06 • Barista: I'll ask our lead and keep the drink unmade while they check with you.

07 • Customer: Please also make sure the no-vanilla request stays attached to my order afterward.

08 • Barista: Certainly. That's separate from the allergy question; I won't lose that preference.

09 • Customer: Could I see the current oat carton information while we're waiting for the lead?

10 • Barista: I'll ask the lead to show you the product information and explain the remaining questions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

No syrup doesn't describe the carton

A customer clarifies what they mean by less sweet.

01 • Barista: You asked for unsweetened. Do you mean no syrup, or a particular milk product too?

02 • Customer: I mainly mean no syrup. I don't know whether the oat drink itself is sweetened.

03 • Barista: I'll show you the oat drink's ingredients. A milk alternative can contain sweeteners of its own.

04 • Customer: Please do. I'm choosing by taste, not asking you to make a medical recommendation.

05 • Barista: Understood. We can compare the listed options without promising how sweet each will taste to you.

06 • Customer: Then leave out the vanilla syrup and keep the oat product shown on this carton.

07 • Barista: I'll enter no vanilla syrup, not describe the complete drink as having no sweeteners.

08 • Customer: That's the distinction I needed. Please keep the drink size and coffee choice unchanged.

09 • Barista: Medium hot latte with oat drink, no vanilla syrup; the other choices stay as ordered.

10 • Customer: Yes. That gives me the change I asked for without guessing about the whole recipe.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Checking the actual product

A barista asks the lead about a customer's ingredient question.

01 • Barista: The customer asks whether our chocolate sauce contains milk. I haven't answered from memory.

02 • Lead: Which product are we using today? A similar bottle was delivered with a different label.

03 • Barista: This is the bottle at the bar, but I haven't compared its information with the delivery.

04 • Lead: Let's check this exact product. A previous brand's ingredient list won't settle today's question.

05 • Barista: The customer hasn't said whether it's an allergy or a preference. Shall I ask?

06 • Lead: Yes, ask directly and relay their words. Keep the ingredient check underway as well.

07 • Barista: I'll say we're checking today's sauce, not that removing whipped cream answers the question.

08 • Lead: Good. The topping and sauce are separate components, so both need their own accurate description.

09 • Barista: I'll leave the drink pending and bring back the customer's stated concern to you.

10 • Lead: Then I can discuss the current information with them before they decide what to order.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying milk, syrup, and allergy questions

A customer reports a milk allergy and asks for an oat latte without vanilla syrup. The barista knows oat drink is available but has not checked its current ingredients or shared-equipment arrangements. No claim of suitability can be made from the drink name.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: state the milk allergy and ask about shared equipment before choosing.

Second round: A colleague says plant-based always means suitable. Explain what that label doesn't establish.

Scenario 2 | A syrup is already in the base

A seasonal drink uses a premixed base that includes vanilla. The customer wants that drink with no vanilla. The lead confirms vanilla cannot be removed from this batch. A plain hot latte is available; the lead has checked its current ingredients and confirmed they contain no vanilla. It does not use the seasonal base. This ingredient check does not establish allergy suitability or rule out cross-contact.

Role A: Barista: explain the premixed base's limit and offer the plain hot latte as a different recipe, not an allergy-safe guarantee.

Role B: Customer: ask whether omitting a final syrup addition removes vanilla already in the base.

Possible opening: The base already contains vanilla; leaving out an extra addition wouldn't remove it.

Success checks

- Identify the premixed component.
- Avoid promising removal from the existing base.
- Ask whether the customer wants the plain hot latte without making an allergy-safety guarantee.

Add a complication: The customer thought 'no syrup' would change the entire recipe.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two Sams at the counter

The duplicated pickup name in the case.

01 • Customer: You called Sam. Is this my large iced decaf latte on ticket sixty-seven?

02 • Barista: This is a small hot latte on sixty-four, for another customer named Sam.

03 • Customer: Thanks for checking. I heard my name and didn't look closely at the drink.

04 • Barista: Your iced decaf is still in progress. I'll call Sam and sixty-seven together.

05 • Customer: Has my mobile order reached the bar, or should I show you the confirmation again?

06 • Barista: It's on the order queue as sixty-seven. You don't need to submit it again.

07 • Customer: All right. Can I wait over here without blocking the drinks being collected?

08 • Barista: Yes, that space is clear. I'll call sixty-seven and describe the drink as well.

09 • Customer: Please do. Two identical names made me think the first call was mine.

10 • Barista: Here's sixty-seven now: large iced decaf latte. Please compare that with your ticket before collection.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Received doesn't mean ready

A customer interprets a mobile confirmation.

01 • Customer: My phone says order received, but I can't see the drinks on the shelf.

02 • Barista: Received means the order reached us. It doesn't yet mean both drinks are ready.

03 • Customer: I thought the confirmation was a collection message. Can you check its current status?

04 • Barista: Certainly. What's the order number shown on that confirmation, rather than your payment details?

05 • Customer: It's eighty-five, under Morgan. There should be two drinks and one plain pastry.

06 • Barista: I see it. One drink is complete, while the second drink and pastry are pending.

07 • Customer: Would you like me to take the finished drink now and return for the rest?

08 • Barista: We can keep the order together if you prefer; tell me which arrangement works for you.

09 • Customer: Together, please. I'd rather collect once than risk forgetting one of the items.

10 • Barista: I'll keep the completed drink linked to eighty-five and call when the full order is ready.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A courier has a different number

A counter worker resolves a pickup-identifier mismatch.

01 • Courier: I'm collecting order thirty-two, but the bag here shows the customer's name without that number.

02 • Counter worker: Let's match the order before handing it over. What identifier does your pickup screen show?

03 • Courier: It shows cafe order one-thirty-two. I shortened that when I first spoke to you.

04 • Counter worker: Thanks. We also have a separate thirty-two, so the full number makes a difference.

05 • Courier: The one-thirty-two order should have three drinks. I don't need the other customer's details.

06 • Counter worker: Correct. This grouped order has three drinks and the matching full reference on its ticket.

07 • Courier: Can you confirm all three are part of this pickup, rather than separate counter orders?

08 • Counter worker: Yes, the ticket lists three, and all three are linked to one-thirty-two here.

09 • Courier: That matches my screen. I'll use the full number when I confirm collection.

10 • Counter worker: Thank you. I'll record this order as collected, leaving thirty-two's status unchanged.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Managing the queue and pickup

Two customers named Sam have orders. Ticket 64 is a small hot latte and is complete. Ticket 67 is a large iced decaf latte and is in progress. The customer collecting 67 hears 'Sam' and reaches for 64. Clarify using ticket and drink details.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you are Sam with ticket 67 and expect an iced drink.

Second round: The label is partly hidden. Check the ticket rather than guessing from the name.

Scenario 2 | Two out of three drinks ready

A customer ordered three drinks on ticket 48. Two are complete; the decaf is pending. The customer asks whether the whole order is ready.

Role A: Barista: state partial progress and offer grouped collection.

Role B: Customer: prefer to collect all three together.

Possible opening: Two drinks are ready; the decaf is still being prepared.

Success checks

- Identify the missing drink.
- Confirm grouped collection.
- Call the whole order only when complete.

Add a complication: A friend reaches for the two cups without knowing one drink remains.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The label contradicts the ticket

The uncollected drink on ticket 22 from the case.

01 • Customer: This cup label says hot vanilla, but my ticket is for an iced latte without syrup.

02 • Barista: You're right. Those details don't match, and I'm sorry for the mix-up here.

03 • Customer: Please don't just change the writing on the cup. I want the drink I ordered.

04 • Barista: I'll request a fresh remake using the ticket details, then check the expected wait.

05 • Customer: Is it still going to be a small, or will the replacement size change?

06 • Barista: It stays small unless you request a change. Would you still like the original specifications?

07 • Customer: Yes: small iced latte, whole milk, and no syrup added to that drink.

08 • Barista: I've repeated those details to the bar. They estimate three minutes for the replacement.

09 • Customer: Thank you. I'll wait here, and please use my ticket number when you call it.

10 • Barista: I will. That's ticket twenty-two; I'll check the label against these details at pickup.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A taste complaint needs a question

A barista clarifies a drink concern without diagnosing the preparation.

01 • Customer: This latte tastes much sweeter than I expected. I can't tell what's different.

02 • Barista: I'm sorry it isn't what you expected. Did you request the version without vanilla syrup?

03 • Customer: Yes, and the label says no vanilla. I can't tell whether that's what was made.

04 • Barista: The label shows the request, but I'll ask the bar to check the preparation.

05 • Customer: Please don't tell me I'm imagining it. I just want the less-sweet drink I ordered.

06 • Barista: I understand. I'll describe the sweetness concern and confirm your preferred order for a remake.

07 • Customer: I'd like the same milk and size, with no vanilla added to the replacement.

08 • Barista: Understood. The milk itself has its listed ingredients; I won't promise the whole drink is unsweetened.

09 • Customer: That's fine. I'm only asking you to leave out the additional vanilla syrup.

10 • Barista: I'll relay that exact change and check the remake estimate with the bar.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A complaint about texture

A customer explains that foam, not coffee strength, is the issue.

01 • Barista: You said the drink wasn't right. Is the concern its temperature, flavor, or texture?

02 • Customer: The foam is the issue. I expected less of it when I ordered this latte.

03 • Barista: Thank you for explaining. You're not asking for more coffee or a different milk, correct?

04 • Customer: Correct. I'd like the same coffee and milk, with the foam request clarified to the bar.

05 • Barista: I'll ask which remake option they can offer under our drink menu today.

06 • Customer: Please check first. I don't want to wait for a drink that repeats the same problem.

07 • Barista: The bar can remake your latte with the less-foam request noted on the ticket.

08 • Customer: That works. Is the replacement already underway, or are you waiting for my decision?

09 • Barista: I was waiting for your choice. I'll confirm it now and ask for the estimated wait.

10 • Customer: Thanks. The texture was the problem; I'm happy to keep everything else the same.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handling remakes and mistaken labels

Ticket 22 requests a small iced latte with no syrup, but the cup label says hot vanilla latte. The customer hasn't collected it. A replacement is available; its wait hasn't been checked. Correct the mismatch without claiming a refund or a serving time.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: keep the original iced, no-syrup order and ask about the wait.

Second round: The bar offers a different size. Check whether the customer wants that change rather than assuming.

Scenario 2 | Wrong pickup, not wrong recipe

A customer's ticket is 18, but they are holding unconsumed drink 81. Both names are Alex. The customer's drink is still at the bar.

Role A: Barista: identify the mismatch and consult the lead about the wrongly collected drink.

Role B: Customer: confirm ticket 18 and ask for the correct drink.

Possible opening: Let's compare the full ticket number before discussing a recipe change.

Success checks

- Distinguish pickup error from recipe error.
- Locate the correct order.
- Refer handling of the collected drink to workplace practice without inventing steps.

Add a complication: The customer asks you to put drink 81 back on the pickup shelf.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Normal ground for an unknown brewer

The gift-bag purchase from the case.

01 • Customer: Could you grind this gift bag normally? I don't know much about their coffee maker.

02 • Barista: Which brewer does the recipient use? We need that detail before choosing a grind size.

03 • Customer: I'm not sure. I only know they make coffee at home every morning.

04 • Barista: Then we can leave the beans whole while you check, since grinding can't be undone.

05 • Customer: That sounds better. Does the hazelnut note mean hazelnut flavoring has been added?

06 • Barista: It's a tasting description, not an ingredient declaration. We can check the actual product information.

07 • Customer: Please do. I don't want to describe the gift incorrectly when I hand it over.

08 • Barista: I'll show you the package information and keep any ingredient question separate from the flavor notes.

09 • Customer: Thanks. I'll buy the whole-bean bag and ask about their brewer before requesting grinding.

10 • Barista: Certainly. I'll leave the package unchanged and confirm the whole-bean item at the till.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A roast date is not a purchase date

A customer compares a bag's roast date with the purchase date and asks about its printed storage guidance. No universal freshness guarantee is established.

01 • Customer: This sticker has a roast date, and my receipt will have today's date. Which describes the coffee?

02 • Barista: The roast date identifies when it was roasted. Today's receipt date records your purchase.

03 • Customer: I thought the older date meant the shop had already sold and returned this bag.

04 • Barista: No, that date alone doesn't indicate a return. It refers to the roasting event.

05 • Customer: Where are the storage instructions on the bag?

06 • Barista: They're printed here on the back, below the label.

07 • Customer: Please also confirm this is the whole-bean version, because the shelf had ground bags nearby.

08 • Barista: The package says whole bean. We haven't ground this bag or changed its contents.

09 • Customer: That's the one I want. I'll keep the dates separate when explaining it at home.

10 • Barista: I'll ring up the whole-bean bag, and your receipt will show today's purchase date.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A description, not an ingredient promise

A barista explains a coffee's chocolate tasting note.

01 • Customer: The label says chocolate notes. Does that mean this bag contains chocolate or milk?

02 • Barista: Those words describe perceived flavor. They don't by themselves tell us the complete ingredient information.

03 • Customer: I'm asking because I need to check ingredients, not because I want a sweeter taste.

04 • Barista: Then let's consult the product information for that question rather than interpret the tasting note.

05 • Customer: Can you also ask your lead about any information the label doesn't make clear?

06 • Barista: Certainly. I'll leave that question open until they can confirm what information we have.

07 • Customer: Would choosing the bag with citrus notes avoid the need for that ingredient check?

08 • Barista: No, a different flavor description wouldn't settle it. We'd still need the relevant product details.

09 • Customer: I'll wait for those details before choosing either bag, then. Please don't grind one yet.

10 • Barista: Of course. Both bags can stay as they are while we clarify your question.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Discussing coffee beans for home

A customer buys a gift bag and asks for 'normal ground.' They don't know the recipient's brewer. This cafe sells the same coffee whole or ground. Grinding cannot be undone. The package's 'hazelnut' note describes flavor, not an ingredient statement.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you are buying a gift and don't know the brewer; decide whether to keep the bag whole.

Second round: The customer asks whether 'hazelnut notes' guarantees an ingredient is absent. Refer to actual product information.

Scenario 2 | Grinding request after checkout

A customer bought whole beans but now requests grinding. They say 'for a press' but mean either a French press or an espresso device. The bag has not been opened by staff.

Role A: Barista: ask which brewer they actually own.

Role B: Customer: you mean a French press with a plunger; explain when asked.

Possible opening: When you say press, which type of brewer do you mean?

Success checks

- Obtain a concrete brewer description.
- Repeat the understood equipment type.
- Check the cafe's grinding option before changing the product.

Add a complication: The customer calls both devices a coffee machine.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The upcharge remains in the combo

The fictional combo prices from the case.

- 01 • Customer:** Your sign says six dollars for a latte and pastry. Does that include oat drink?
- 02 • Barista:** The combo includes the standard latte; the fifty-cent oat upcharge still applies to that choice.
- 03 • Customer:** So my oat latte with this pastry would be six fifty altogether for those items?
- 04 • Barista:** Yes. The same selected items bought separately would total seven fifty on our menu.
- 05 • Customer:** Then the combo saves a dollar, not a dollar and fifty cents, correct?
- 06 • Barista:** Correct. Both versions include the same oat change, so the saving is one dollar.
- 07 • Customer:** I'll choose the combo. Please keep the drink size that qualifies for this offer.
- 08 • Barista:** Certainly. That's the listed small latte size; your oat choice stays on the ticket.
- 09 • Customer:** Thank you for explaining the upcharge before payment. I didn't see the small-print condition.
- 10 • Barista:** I'll enter the six-fifty combo and show you the item details before you pay.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A sold-out pastry is a choice point

A counter worker asks before substituting a pastry.

01 • Counter worker: The cinnamon pastry has just sold out. We still have plain pastries at the same price.

02 • Customer: I ordered cinnamon because of the flavor. Please don't just put a plain one in the bag.

03 • Counter worker: Of course. Would you like the plain alternative, another listed item, or no pastry today?

04 • Customer: No pastry, please. Can I keep the coffee order without the combo?

05 • Counter worker: Yes. I'll change it to the standalone coffee price and explain the revised total.

06 • Customer: Does that mean the coffee still costs its normal four dollars rather than the combo price?

07 • Counter worker: Correct. The standard coffee alone is four dollars, with no pastry included in that amount.

08 • Customer: That works. Please confirm the pastry has been removed before I make the payment.

09 • Counter worker: The ticket now shows one standard coffee only. There's no pastry or combo charge.

10 • Customer: Thank you. I wanted to choose, even though the alternative pastry cost the same.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A reward has a specific condition

A fictional reward covers a standard filter coffee, not all drinks.

01 • Customer: My account has a loyalty reward for a free drink. Does it cover a large specialty latte?

02 • Counter worker: The displayed reward here covers a standard filter coffee; it doesn't list the specialty latte.

03 • Customer: I thought free drink meant any drink. Can you show me the condition on the offer?

04 • Counter worker: Certainly. This line specifies the filter coffee and eligible size, rather than the whole menu.

05 • Customer: Could I pay only the difference for the latte, or is that not stated?

06 • Counter worker: That option isn't stated here. I'll ask the lead instead of inventing an exchange value.

07 • Customer: Please do. Don't use the reward while we're checking, because I may save it.

08 • Counter worker: Understood. It remains unused while the lead confirms whether any alternative arrangement is available.

09 • Customer: If there isn't one, I'll buy the latte normally and keep the reward for later.

10 • Counter worker: I'll confirm the lead's answer with you before choosing either option at the till.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining counter prices and sold-out items

A fictional cafe lists a latte at \$4, an oat-drink upcharge of \$0.50, and a pastry at \$3. The \$6 combo includes a standard latte and pastry; the oat upcharge still applies. Explain \$6.50 for that combo, versus \$7.50 separately, before payment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: compare the oat combo with the separate prices and choose one.

Second round: The selected pastry sells out before payment. Ask whether the customer wants the remaining pastry; don't substitute silently.

Scenario 2 | A larger cup falls outside an offer

The fictional \$5 combo includes a small filter coffee and a plain pastry. A large coffee costs \$4 separately; the pastry costs \$3. No large-drink combo is listed.

Role A: Counter worker: explain the actual included size.

Role B: Customer: decide between the small combo and \$7 separate items.

Possible opening: The five-dollar combo uses the small coffee; would that size work for you?

Success checks

- Name the included size.
- State both complete choices.
- Get a choice before payment.

Add a complication: The customer assumes the large upgrade is free.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

One tea, one stockout, one review

The 2:00 handover from the case.

01 • Outgoing worker: Ticket one-oh-eight has its coffee, but the tea is still waiting to be prepared.

02 • Incoming worker: I'll take the tea. Is that the only unfinished drink on the current order queue?

03 • Outgoing worker: Yes. Large takeaway lids are also out, although small lids are still available here.

04 • Incoming worker: I'll ask the lead about the large-lid stockout before offering a different packaging arrangement.

05 • Outgoing worker: Thanks. I've counted the till, but the reconciliation with the sales record is pending.

06 • Incoming worker: Are you keeping that review, or do you need me to take it over?

07 • Outgoing worker: I'll stay with it until the lead accepts the follow-up. You have the tea and lid query.

08 • Incoming worker: Understood. I won't call the till signed off simply because the count has been completed.

09 • Outgoing worker: Please let the customer know the tea is outstanding, so they don't leave with only coffee.

10 • Incoming worker: I will. I'll check their full order at pickup and ask about the lids next.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A float is not today's takings

A new counter worker clarifies the till count.

01 • Counter worker: The drawer count includes the cash float. Does the whole amount represent today's cash sales?

02 • Lead: No. The float is starting change cash, so keep it distinct from the transaction record.

03 • Counter worker: I haven't done the reconciliation yet. I was about to report the whole drawer as takings.

04 • Lead: Please describe it as the counted drawer amount until we've compared the appropriate records.

05 • Counter worker: There's also a difference between my count and the figure on this summary.

06 • Lead: Report the two figures without deciding whether it means a missed sale or another issue.

07 • Counter worker: I'll bring you the count and the summary, with the cause of the difference unconfirmed.

08 • Lead: Good. Don't assign blame or invent an adjustment to make the numbers appear to match.

09 • Counter worker: Will you take the reconciliation review while I return to the counter orders?

10 • Lead: Yes, I've accepted that review. I'll ask you for any clarification about your count.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Which cup size is actually missing?

A barista clarifies a supply shortage before updating the counter.

01 • Barista: You said we're out of cups. Which size and service type does that affect?

02 • Counter colleague: Large takeaway cups only. The small takeaway cups and dine-in mugs are still stocked.

03 • Barista: Thanks. I'll tell the counter the exact size rather than describe every drink as unavailable.

04 • Counter colleague: Please ask the lead about the available service choices before promising a substitute container.

05 • Barista: I will. A customer may prefer a different size, but we should ask them first.

06 • Counter colleague: Exactly. Their choice could change the order and price, so don't silently swap the size.

07 • Barista: I'll check the permitted options and explain them before the customer decides whether to order.

08 • Counter colleague: Meanwhile, I'll count the small cups so our update includes the stock we actually have.

09 • Barista: Good. Please report that count when it's complete, not an estimate from looking at the sleeve.

10 • Counter colleague: I'll do that. The confirmed shortage remains large takeaway cups, with the small-cup count pending.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handing over the bar and till

At 2:00, ticket 108's coffee is complete but its tea is pending. Large takeaway lids are unavailable, though small lids remain. The outgoing worker counted the till, but the lead's reconciliation is pending. Assign the tea and stock follow-up without calling the till signed off.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Incoming worker: accept the tea follow-up and large-lid query; ask who retains the till review.

Second round: A coworker says the till 'looks about right.' Keep the unresolved record comparison explicit.

Scenario 2 | A pickup has no completion mark

Ticket 120 shows two coffees but no collection status. The cups aren't on the shelf. The outgoing worker didn't witness pickup; the lead can check the order history.

Role A: Outgoing worker: report what you know and don't know.

Role B: Incoming worker: accept the status check without marking collected from appearance alone.

Possible opening: I can't confirm whether ticket 120 was collected.

Success checks

- Separate shelf observation from pickup confirmation.
- Identify ticket 120.
- Assign the check and preserve uncertain status.

Add a complication: A colleague assumes an empty shelf proves collection.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All orders, prices, recipes, promotions, and incidents are fictional language practice, not barista certification, allergen-control training, health advice, or equipment-maintenance instruction. Recipes and terminology vary by cafe. Use current workplace information and refer suitability or equipment questions to the designated lead. This course focuses on counter and coffee-bar exchanges, not hospitality management.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook: Food and Beverage Serving and Related Workers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/food-preparation-and-serving/food-and-beverage-serving-and-related-workers.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Baristas

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/35-3023.01>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Baristas and Cafe Staff English

Professional audience: Baristas, cafe counter staff, and coffee pickup staff

Scope: All orders, prices, recipes, promotions, and incidents are fictional language practice, not barista certification, allergen-control training, health advice, or equipment-maintenance instruction. Recipes and terminology vary by cafe. Use current workplace information and refer suitability or equipment questions to the designated lead. This course focuses on counter and coffee-bar exchanges, not hospitality management.

Dialogue 01: Two drinks, one speaker

Original fictional setting: A barista separates specifications when one person orders two similar drinks.

Professional roles: Barista / Customer

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Barista: You mentioned two lattes, one different from the other. Let's check each drink separately.

Customer: The first is a small hot latte with whole milk, for me to drink here.

Barista: Thanks. Is that first latte standard coffee, or would you like the decaf option today?

Customer: Standard coffee. The second one is decaf, and it needs to be iced for my colleague.

Barista: What size would your colleague like, and should that second drink also use whole milk?

Customer: A large, with oat drink instead. They're taking it away rather than staying in the cafe.

Barista: I'll attach the oat choice to the large iced decaf only, not to your small hot latte.

Customer: That's right. Can you put separate names on them so we don't mix them up?

Barista: Yes. What names should I use for your drink and for your colleague's takeaway order?

Customer: Mine is Rowan, and theirs is Lee. Please don't add any syrups to either drink.

Barista: Rowan: small hot standard latte, whole milk. Lee: large iced decaf latte, oat drink; neither has syrup.

Customer: Exactly. Mine is for here and Lee's is takeaway. Those final details match what we want.

Vocabulary in this exchange: decaf: Coffee from which most caffeine has been removed; it is not necessarily caffeine-free. / latte: An espresso drink with milk; proportions and serving styles vary by cafe. / syrup: A flavored liquid sweetener used in some cafe drinks.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
 2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
 3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
 4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
 5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.
- Use voice replies when available. If I prefer selections, offer four plausible spoken replies and explain my choice before continuing. Do not require written compositions.

END PROMPT

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

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Vocabulary in this exchange: decaf: Coffee from which most caffeine has been removed; it is not necessarily caffeine-free. / latte: An espresso drink with milk; proportions and serving styles vary by cafe. / syrup: A flavored liquid sweetener used in some cafe drinks.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT